

Prestige journalism, commercial utility

An executable affiliate marketing playbook for a magazine built around leaders, legacy, diplomacy and luxury life.

DISCLOSURE POLICY · LIKE® RECOMMENDS · STYLE + TRAVEL PILOT
EDITORIAL INDEPENDENCE · PHOTOGRAPHY SYSTEM · LAUNCH WORKFLOW

Commerce should become a new desk - not a new motive

LIKE® already has the right audience and the right departments. The opportunity is to add service journalism without making readers question the integrity of profiles, diplomacy coverage or institutional reporting.

The recommendation

Launch **LIKE® Recommends** as a visibly labeled commerce franchise inside Style and Travel & Tourism. Keep leader profiles and reported features affiliate-free by default. Let products and bookings support a story; never let commission create the story.

The reader promise

We select independently. We disclose every material connection. A commission may support the magazine, but it does not buy praise, placement or protection from criticism.

Four decisions to make now

1 / PUBLISH THE POLICY

Put a plain-language Affiliate Policy in the footer and a short disclosure at the top of every commerce article, before the first monetized link.

2 / NAME THE LANE

Use LIKE® Recommends for independent commerce. Reserve “Paid Partnership” for content commissioned or controlled by an advertiser.

3 / PILOT WHERE INTENT EXISTS

Begin with Style and Travel & Tourism: high visual value, useful buying decisions and a natural fit with the current editorial architecture.

4 / GOVERN BEFORE SCALING

Assign editorial approval, link operations, rights clearance, disclosure review and corrections before the first article goes live.

Legal note. The policy copy in this playbook is an operational draft, not legal advice. Have counsel review it for the magazine's ownership structure, affiliate networks, privacy practices and jurisdictions before publication.

Three lanes make the relationship legible before the first paragraph

A label is not decoration. It is a contract with the reader. Put the lane above the headline, in archive cards and in social promotion.

01

Editorial

NEWS • PROFILE •
REPORTAGE

Commissioned for journalistic relevance. No affiliate links by default. Sources, subjects and institutions do not buy favorable treatment.

- Independent assignment
- Normal fact-check and corrections
- No commerce call-to-action

02

LIKE® Recommends

INDEPENDENT COMMERCE

Chosen and written by the editorial team for usefulness. May contain affiliate links. Commercial relationships do not determine conclusions.

- Top-of-article disclosure
- Selection criteria stated
- “Sponsored” link attribute

03

Paid Partnership

ADVERTISING STUDIO

Funded or commissioned by a brand. The sponsor and nature of its role are named prominently. It never appears under an ordinary editorial label.

- Advertiser named
- Approval rights disclosed
- Separate visual treatment

Do not create a gray fourth lane

PUBLISH AS EDITORIAL WHEN...

- The story would run without any commercial relationship.
- The subject has no copy approval.
- No call-to-action is necessary to complete the journalism.

PUBLISH AS COMMERCE OR PAID WHEN...

- A purchase or booking is part of the reader service.
- A brand supplied money, travel, product or unusual access.
- The brand negotiated deliverables, timing or approval.

Site-wide Affiliate Policy / page 1

EFFECTIVE ON PUBLICATION · DRAFT FOR LEGAL REVIEW

Affiliate relationships

LIKE® Magazine publishes journalism, criticism, recommendations and service features. Some articles contain links to products, hotels, travel services or other offers from third parties. When a reader makes a purchase or booking through certain links, LIKE® Magazine may receive a commission or other compensation. This does not increase the price paid by the reader unless a retailer or booking provider states otherwise.

How selections are made

Our editors select subjects and make recommendations independently. The possibility of earning a commission does not guarantee coverage, favorable treatment, a particular ranking or continued inclusion. We aim to recommend only products and services that are relevant to the article and meet the criteria stated or implied by the feature.

Where disclosures appear

Articles containing affiliate links carry a clear disclosure near the beginning of the article and before the first affiliate link. We also distinguish independent commerce journalism, such as LIKE® Recommends, from paid advertising or sponsored content. A general policy page does not replace article-level disclosure.

Gifts, loans, travel and access

If a brand, hotel, tourism board or other organization provides a product, service, trip, accommodation, admission, unusual access or other benefit that could affect how readers evaluate our coverage, we disclose that connection in the relevant article. A loaned product remains the property of the provider unless stated otherwise. Acceptance of a benefit does not promise positive coverage.

Sponsored content

Content funded or commissioned by an advertiser is labeled "Paid Partnership," "Sponsored" or another equally clear term. The advertiser is identified. Sponsored content is not presented as ordinary newsroom reporting or as an independent recommendation.

Site-wide Affiliate Policy / page 2

Prices, availability and third-party terms

Prices, availability, policies and offers can change after publication. We identify the date or time of our last check when price or availability is material. Purchases, bookings, returns, cancellations, warranties and customer service are governed by the terms of the retailer, hotel, booking provider or other third party.

Reviews and corrections

Reviews reflect the honest opinions of the named writer or editorial team at the time of publication. We do not alter a review to satisfy an advertiser or affiliate partner. If a material factual error is identified, we correct it promptly and disclose the correction when appropriate. We may update links, prices, availability and product status without changing the editorial conclusion.

Data and tracking

Affiliate links may include identifiers that allow a network or merchant to attribute a purchase or booking to LIKE® Magazine. Any collection or use of personal data is also governed by the magazine's Privacy Policy and the policies of the third-party destination. Readers should review those policies before completing a transaction.

Questions

Questions about an article's commercial relationships, disclosures or corrections may be sent through the editorial contact method published by LIKE® Magazine. We welcome specific information that helps us keep coverage accurate and transparent.

Required page furniture

FOOTER LINK

Affiliate Policy should appear beside Privacy, Terms and Corrections on every page of the site.

ARTICLE METADATA

Show the content lane, author, publication date and updated date above the article body.

Do not state or imply that affiliate links "never affect" coverage unless the operating rules on page 7 are actually enforced. Policy copy must describe practice, not aspiration.

The short disclosure must be unavoidable and ordinary-language clear

Place the disclosure below the deck and above the first image, product module or affiliate link. Do not hide it behind “More,” a tooltip, a footer or the policy page.

STANDARD AFFILIATE ARTICLE

Disclosure: LIKE® Magazine may earn a commission if you buy or book through links in this article. Our editors select recommendations independently.

PRODUCT SUPPLIED OR LOANED

Disclosure: The featured brand provided the product for review. LIKE® Magazine did not receive payment for this coverage. We may earn a commission from purchases made through links in this article.

HOSTED TRAVEL

Disclosure: Part of this stay was hosted by the property. The hotel did not approve this article or its conclusions. LIKE® Magazine may earn a commission from bookings made through links in this article.

PAID PARTNERSHIP PLUS AFFILIATE LINKS

Paid Partnership: This article was commissioned and paid for by the named partner. The partner’s role is described below. LIKE® Magazine may also earn a commission from purchases or bookings made through links in this article.

SOCIAL POST

Affiliate links: LIKE® may earn a commission from purchases made through this post.

USE

- “Affiliate links” and “earn a commission”
- Specific benefits: hosted stay, gifted item, payment
- Text large enough to read on mobile

AVOID

- “May contain compensated links” by itself
- Disclosure only in a biography or footer
- Color or type that recedes into the page

FTC guidance describes a clear and conspicuous disclosure as difficult to miss and easily understandable to ordinary consumers. It also says a disclosure should be placed with the endorsement itself, not only on a general policy page.

Independence is an operating system, not a sentence in the footer

These rules should be approved by the editor in chief, commerce lead and publisher, then applied to staff, freelancers and outside studios.

Assignment

- Profiles, diplomacy coverage, obituaries, investigations and institutional reporting are affiliate-free by default.
- A commercial team may suggest reader needs, never a required conclusion, subject or ranking.
- Writers disclose financial, family and close personal interests before assignment.

Selection

- Editors document why each item serves the reader and what alternatives were considered.
- Commission rate, cookie window or merchant pressure is not a quality criterion.
- “Best” requires a defined field, method and meaningful comparison.

Access

- Gifts, loans and hosted travel are logged with value, provider and disposition.
- No guarantee of coverage is offered in exchange for access or product.

Copy control

- Affiliate partners receive no advance approval of independent copy.
- Brands may correct verifiable facts; editors retain wording, tone and verdict.
- Paid partnership approval rights are documented and disclosed.

Placement

- Ads and commerce modules never interrupt a sensitive profile, memorial or public-interest report.
- Recommendation boxes carry their own label even when the article is labeled.
- Archive cards preserve the original content label.

Maintenance

- Check price, availability and dead links on a scheduled cycle.
- Remove recalled, discontinued or materially changed recommendations.
- Maintain a visible corrections route and an internal change log.

The reader should never have to infer whether admiration was purchased.

LIKE® Recommends should read like a magazine before it behaves like a store

Use this order for every independent commerce feature. The sequence keeps the editorial idea in front and the transaction in its proper place.

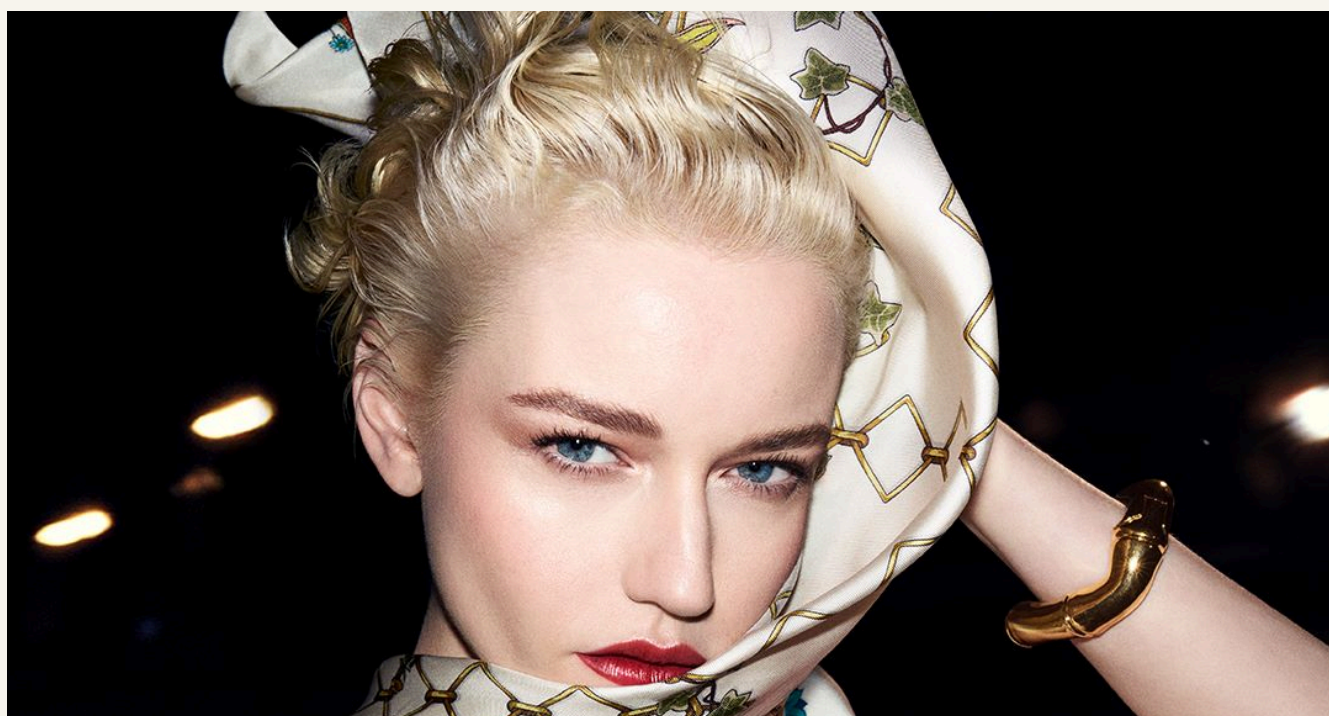
1 · CONTENT LABEL	LIKE® Recommends / Style above the headline; never "Partner Content" unless paid.
2 · HEADLINE + DECK	Lead with a point of view, not a product count. The deck tells readers what problem the feature solves.
3 · BYLINE + DATES	Named author, original publication date, last substantial update and editor.
4 · DISCLOSURE	Short, ordinary-language disclosure before the first monetized link.
5 · HERO IMAGE	Commissioned, licensed or approved brand imagery with rights recorded; caption and credit visible.
6 · EDITORIAL THESIS	Two or three paragraphs that explain the cultural, practical or aesthetic idea before products appear.
7 · SELECTION CRITERIA	What was considered: design, material, service, provenance, durability, accessibility or firsthand testing.
8 · THE EDIT	Each recommendation includes why it belongs, who it suits, material facts, price checked date and one clear call-to-action.
9 · SERVICE BOX	Care, fit, booking, returns, shipping, accessibility or cancellation information.
10 · SOURCES + CORRECTIONS	Primary sources, image credits and a route for corrections; update log when conclusions change.

Technical rule: mark monetized outbound links with `rel="sponsored nofollow"`. Use accessible link text that names the destination or action; avoid "click here."

The art of the arrival

A silk square is small enough to disappear into a pocket and expressive enough to change the temperature of a room. That is precisely why it belongs in the modern travel uniform.

Disclosure: LIKE® Magazine may earn a commission if you buy through links in this article. Our editors select recommendations independently.



Layout demonstration using a Gucci silk campaign image referenced by Miami Fashion Spotlight. Secure publication rights or substitute commissioned photography before use.

Great travel style is less about volume than command. A well-chosen scarf can carry a personal color, soften a formal suit, protect hair in transit or turn a simple coat into an entrance. The test is not how loudly it announces itself, but how many roles it can play without losing its character.

SELECTION CRITERIA

Silk quality · edge finish · colorfastness ·
dimensions · versatility · care
requirements · provenance

The Edit: three roles, one disciplined point of view



Second layout reference from Mixte Magazine's coverage of Gucci's "Art of Silk." Rights clearance required before publication.

Products enter only after the editorial idea is clear. Each recommendation earns its place through a stated use and a verifiable fact.

01

THE DECISIVE SQUARE

A saturated silk twill in a scale that works at the neck, on the head or tied to a structured bag. Name fiber content, dimensions, country of manufacture and care.

[VIEW THE EDITOR'S SELECTION](#)

02

THE QUIET NEUTRAL

A restrained field with a precise border for formal travel. Explain why the palette works across navy, black, camel and evening tailoring.

[VIEW THE EDITOR'S SELECTION](#)

03

THE ARCHIVAL MOTIF

A design with documented provenance. Distinguish house history from marketing language and link the primary source.

[VIEW THE EDITOR'S SELECTION](#)

Three evergreen stories can test the model without bending the newsroom

Publish on a six-week rhythm: one feature every other week. Learn from the format before increasing volume.

WEEK 1 · STYLE

The Art of the Arrival

Promise: Build a summit-ready travel uniform through a small number of decisive accessories.

Modules: Shop the look; care note; selection criteria.

Affiliate fit: Scarves, compact jewelry, leather goods, garment care.

WEEK 3 · TRAVEL

Where Diplomacy Sleeps

Promise: A service-minded guide to grand hotels in three global meeting cities.

Modules: Where to stay; room to request; arrival intelligence.

Affiliate fit: Hotel bookings, airport transfers, travel insurance where editorially appropriate.

WEEK 5 · CROSSOVER

The 48-Hour Case

Promise: What earns space when the itinerary moves from cabin to conference table.

Modules: Pack list; shop the edit; repair and care.

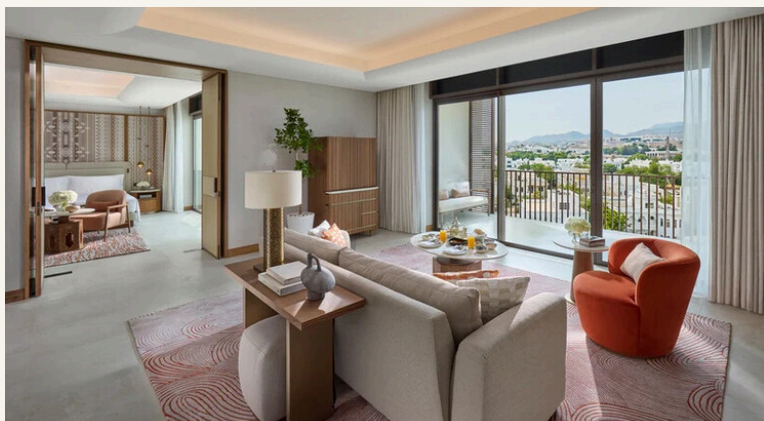
Affiliate fit: Luggage, organizers, steamers, adapters, garment folders.

The assignment memo for every feature

- Reader decision the article helps make
- Editorial thesis that exists without products
- Testing or research method
- Known material connections
- Image plan and rights owner
- Merchant and non-commercial primary sources
- Update owner and review date
- Disclosure variant required

If the pitch cannot survive after the affiliate links are removed, it is merchandising, not editorial service.

Commerce belongs in boxes that explain, not links that interrupt



Travel layout reference: Mandarin Oriental, Muscat image surfaced via Destination2. Confirm license or use property-approved media before publication.

Where to stay

AFFILIATE
MODULE

Why this property: one sentence tied to location, service or cultural relevance.

Know before booking: room category, cancellation window, accessibility, taxes or resort fees.

CHECK ROOMS AND RATES

Shop the look

AFFILIATE
MODULE

Why it belongs: the product's role in the story.

Material facts: composition, dimensions, origin, care.

Price checked: publication or update date.

VIEW AT RETAILER

Rules for module placement

- Put the first module after the article has delivered real editorial value.
- Keep modules visually consistent and clearly labeled.
- Use one purposeful call-to-action, not multiple competing buttons.
- Repeat the disclosure inside a module embedded in an otherwise non-commerce page.
- Never auto-insert modules into profiles, obituaries or sensitive reporting.
- Do not link every brand mention; monetization should not distort the prose.
- Do not use scarcity language unless the merchant's claim is verified and time-stamped.
- Keep ordinary source links visually distinct from purchase links.

Photography should carry authority before it carries inventory

LIKE® is already image-led and folio-minded. Commerce should deepen that identity, not replace it with e-commerce thumbnails.

Commission the story, then the objects

- **Hero:** one cinematic, editorial image that establishes place, person or point of view.
- **Context:** show the object in use - at an arrival, a table, a suite or in transit.
- **Detail:** include craftsmanship, texture or construction where it supports the recommendation.
- **Utility:** product-only imagery belongs in “The Edit,” not as the article’s emotional center.



Context reference from Cathay Pacific’s sustainability publication. Confirm rights before publication.

IMAGE STANDARDS

- Rights record for every asset
- Minimum 2,400 px long edge for a new hero
- 3:2 landscape hero; 4:5 portrait companion; 1:1 commerce card
- Consistent color grade across each folio
- Human-written alt text describing visible content

TRUST STANDARDS

- No synthetic product image presented as documentary photography
- No beauty retouching that changes a tested product’s appearance
- Label photo illustration or composite work
- Credit photographer, archive or brand source
- Caption hosted access when relevant to interpretation

Brand-supplied imagery is not neutral. It may be used when rights are clear, but captions should identify the source and the article must retain independent selection and wording.

Every article passes five gates before the affiliate link goes live

Assign one owner to each gate. “Everyone checks” usually means no one does.

1 · Assign Define the reader decision, lane, disclosure type and independence risks.	2 · Report Test or research; keep primary sources, receipts, product notes and competing options.	3 · Edit Confirm thesis, criteria, claims, label and the distance between prose and commerce.	4 · Clear Verify image rights, material connections, affiliate terms and legal disclosure.	5 · Publish Test links, mobile disclosure, analytics, accessibility, dates and correction route.
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ROLE	OWNS	CANNOT CONTROL
Editor in chief	Lane definitions, sensitive-story exclusions, final editorial policy.	Network payout terms or merchant placement demands.
Commerce editor	Service assignments, selection records, updates and recommendation integrity.	Paid partnership approval or newsroom profiles.
Commercial lead	Affiliate relationships, tracking, merchant operations and revenue reporting.	Independent verdicts, rankings or negative findings.
Managing editor	Disclosure checklist, credits, corrections and archive labels.	Retroactive relabeling to improve commercial performance.
Developer / producer	Link attributes, modules, mobile visibility, analytics and broken-link alerts.	Which products or properties are endorsed.

Article record to retain

- Assignment memo and selection criteria
- Material-connections declaration
- Source and testing notes
- Image licenses and credits
- Disclosure used and reviewer
- Link destinations and last check

Pilot for learning, not volume

The launch sequence protects trust first, then tests whether the service format earns reader action.

Week 0

APPROVE THE RULES

Legal review of policy and disclosures; designate the three content lanes; add Affiliate Policy, Corrections and Privacy links to the footer.

Week 1

PUBLISH STYLE

Launch The Art of the Arrival. Test disclosure visibility, image treatment, link attributes, mobile reading and analytics events.

Week 2

READ BEHAVIOR, NOT JUST REVENUE

Review scroll depth before the first module, disclosure visibility, outbound click quality, reader feedback and broken links.

Week 3

PUBLISH TRAVEL

Launch Where Diplomacy Sleeps with hosted-stay language ready, room-level service notes and booking terms checked.

Week 5

PUBLISH THE CROSSOVER

Launch The 48-Hour Case. Compare category intent without changing the editorial standard.

Week 6

HOLD AN EDITORIAL REVIEW

Decide what to keep, revise or stop. Scale only if disclosures are flawless, reader trust is intact and the format earns meaningful action.

100%

of monetized articles carry a tested article-level disclosure.

0

unresolved rights, labeling or editorial-policy exceptions at publication.

One owner

is named for every feature's updates, corrections and link maintenance.

Trust is a launch gate; revenue is a diagnostic

A commerce desk can grow only if it remains credible enough to be useful. Report trust and editorial quality beside commercial performance.

DIMENSION	MEASURE	QUESTION ANSWERED
Compliance	Disclosure present; label correct; material connection named; sponsored link attribute present.	Did we keep the promise?
Editorial quality	Corrections, reader complaints, returns to article, update completion, source quality.	Did the story remain worth reading?
Engagement	Scroll depth, module visibility, outbound click-through, engaged time, newsletter signup after article.	Did the format help a decision?
Commercial	Revenue per session, earnings per click, conversion rate, order value, cancellation or return signal where available.	Did reader action create sustainable value?
Portfolio	Revenue concentration by merchant, category and article; expired links; merchant outages.	Where is the desk fragile?

Editorial red lines in the dashboard

NEVER OPTIMIZE TOWARD

- Removing critical caveats to increase conversion
- Replacing an editor's selection with a higher-paying item
- Hiding the disclosure to improve clicks
- Rewriting profiles around purchasable mentions

USE PERFORMANCE TO IMPROVE

- Article structure and service depth
- Mobile module clarity and accessibility
- Merchant reliability and link health
- Update frequency and category planning

The correct first question is not “Did it convert?” It is “Did the reader know what it was?”

The first publish is ready when every box has an owner

Policy + labeling

- Affiliate Policy reviewed and published
- Footer links to Affiliate Policy, Privacy and Corrections
- LIKE® Recommends archive label built
- Paid Partnership label visually distinct
- Disclosure visible before first affiliate link on mobile

Editorial + commercial

- Selection criteria stored with assignment
- Material connections logged
- Brand has no approval rights over independent copy
- Price and availability check dated
- Affiliate and non-commercial primary sources separated

Images + production

- Rights, credits and permitted uses recorded
- Hero and card crops tested
- Alt text written from the actual image
- No synthetic product image presented as fact
- Links use meaningful text and sponsored attributes

After publication

- Disclosure and links tested in live mobile view
- Analytics events verified
- Correction contact working
- Update owner and review date assigned
- Policy incident route known to newsroom and commercial teams

The one-sentence standard

LIKE® may earn from a recommendation; it must never sell the reader's belief that the recommendation was independent.

Primary guidance and visual references

The operating rules are grounded in the current public structure of LIKE® Magazine and Federal Trade Commission guidance on endorsements and material connections.

1. **LIKE® Magazine.** Homepage and department/archive structure, accessed September 16, 2026. <https://likeleaders.com>
2. **Federal Trade Commission.** "The FTC's Endorsement Guides: What People Are Asking." The guidance explains material connections and the need for clear, conspicuous disclosures placed with the endorsement. <https://www.ftc.gov/business-guidance/resources/ftcs-endorsement-guides-what-people-are-asking>
3. **Miami Fashion Spotlight.** Visual reference for Gucci silk campaign. <https://miamifashionspotlight.com/fashion/gucci-silk-scarves/>
4. **Mixte Magazine.** Visual reference for Gucci "The Art of Silk." <https://www.mixtemagazine.com/article/gucci-the-art-of-silk-campaign/>
5. **Destination2.** Visual reference for Mandarin Oriental, Muscat. Image used only to demonstrate editorial layout; publication rights must be separately confirmed.
6. **Cathay Pacific.** Visual reference for lounge context, from its sustainability publication. <https://downloads.cathaypacific.com/cx/aboutus/sd/2014/sustainable-sourcing/index.html>

USE OF THIS PLAYBOOK

The disclosure and policy language is drafted for implementation planning. Final publication should follow counsel review and reflect the magazine's actual affiliate, privacy, tracking, gift and travel practices.

USE OF THE VISUAL EXAMPLES

The images demonstrate hierarchy, cropping and caption practice inside an internal playbook. They are not cleared production assets for a public LIKE® article.